

Online Library Platform — Hosting Plan & Recommendation

Client brief · public book reading & downloads · built to handle ~100,000 visitors in a minute · Aug 2026

Recommendation in one line. We propose building the platform on **Cloudflare**. It is the only option that can absorb a large launch spike (100,000 visitors in a minute) while keeping the running cost to about **\$5 per month** — because Cloudflare does not charge for the data users download. The one thing needed from your side is a verified payment card on the account.

WHY CLOUDFLARE — AND NOT THE ALTERNATIVES

Every hosting option can run a small website. The difference only shows up under two conditions that apply directly to this project: a **sudden traffic spike**, and **lots of people downloading book files**. That download traffic ("egress") is where the other platforms become expensive or fall over.

OPTION	COST OF BOOK DOWNLOADS	HANDLES A 100K/MIN SPIKE?	VERDICT FOR THIS PROJECT
Cloudflare (recommended)	\$0 — no egress fees, files cached worldwide	Yes — pages & files served from a global edge, free	Best fit. Spike costs almost nothing extra.
Amazon AWS / S3	Charged per GB (~\$0.09/GB) — a busy day can cost hundreds	Yes, but every download is billed	Powerful but costly for public file downloads.
Vercel	Bandwidth is metered and billed on spikes	Yes, but a spike can trigger large overage charges	Great for apps, expensive for heavy file traffic.
Traditional VPS / shared host	Limited by one server's network + bandwidth caps	No — a single server physically cannot push that volume	Cannot serve files at this scale on its own.

In short: with the others, the more successful the launch, the bigger the bill (or the more likely the site slows down). With Cloudflare, a big spike costs roughly the same as a quiet day.

WHY \$5 / MONTH IS NEEDED

Almost everything runs on Cloudflare's **free** tier: the domain, the website pages, storing the books (under 10 GB), and unlimited visitors reading cached pages. The single paid item is a **\$5/month plan (Cloudflare "Workers Paid")**, and it is needed for two concrete reasons:

- Spike protection.** The free tier allows about 100,000 requests *per day*. Our target is 100,000 visitors *in a minute*. The \$5 plan raises the ceiling to 10 million requests per month, so the site stays fast and online during a launch rush instead of throttling.
- It powers the interactive features.** The admin panel (adding and managing books), secure admin login, and download tracking all run on this same paid compute. Without it, the site can only be a static page with no management tools.

So \$5/month buys two things: the site stays up under heavy traffic, and you get a working admin/management system. It is a fixed, predictable cost — usage stays comfortably inside what the \$5 covers.

MONTHLY COST AT A GLANCE

ITEM	INCLUDED IN	COST
Custom domain & DNS	Free tier	\$0
Website pages (unlimited visitors, cached)	Free tier	\$0
Book file storage (under 10 GB)	Free tier	\$0
Book downloads (any volume)	Free — no egress fees	\$0
Spike protection + admin & download features	Workers Paid plan	\$5
Total ongoing		~\$5 / month

Predictable fixed cost

No surprise spike bills

Scales without re-architecting

⚠ Payment card required to switch it on

Cloudflare requires a valid **credit or debit card to be added and verified** on the account before the \$5 plan and the book storage can be enabled. This is a Cloudflare account requirement — the card must simply be on file. The actual charge remains only about **\$5/month**; nothing is billed for the free items above.

- ✓ What we need from you**
- A verified payment card on the Cloudflare account** — so we can turn on the \$5/month plan and the book storage. (This is the main blocker; everything else waits on it.)
 - The domain** — either provide your existing domain (with access to update its settings) or approve us to register one for you.
 - The book files and details** — the books to publish (under ~10 GB total) plus their titles, authors, covers, and descriptions.
 - Branding** — logo and preferred colours, if you want the site styled to your brand.
 - Account ownership preference** — we recommend the Cloudflare and domain accounts be in **your** name, so you fully own the platform and the data.

Bottom line. Cloudflare gives you a platform that survives a big launch, lets any visitor read and download books freely, and costs a predictable ~\$5/month. To proceed, we just need the payment card verified on the account — then we can enable everything and begin loading your library.